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Apple has now sold 3
billion iPhones



Apple has sold 3 billion iPhones since the product was launched in 2007, Apple CEO Tim Cook said Thursday during the company's third-quarter earnings call.

It took Apple nine years to sell the billionth iPhone, a milestone the company reached in 2016. This implies that Apple sold 2 billion between 2016 and now — also a nine-year period — marking the product's growing popularity.

While Apple celebrates 3 billion iPhones sold, the company has struggled a bit in the stock market this year, as the tech giant fell behind Nvidia and Microsoft as the market's most highly valued businesses. So perhaps a bigger cause for celebration at Apple is that its iPhone sales were stronger this quarter than expected.

Sales of the iPhone, Apple's most popular product, are up 13% year-over-year, generating \$44.6 billion in revenue, according to information shared on the earnings call. That's nearly half of the entire company's total revenue this quarter, which reached \$94 billion.

This uptick in iPhone sales might be temporary, though. Apple expert and Bloomberg managing editor Mark Gurman mused that the company may have sold more iPhones last quarter over fears that President Trump's tariff plans would exponentially increase prices in the United States.

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Mark Gurman 
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Apple should be very pleased with the folks who spread the lies that the iPhone will cost \$3000 or \$25,000 if made in the U.S. Clearly that helped a ton for the June quarter.

8:50 PM · Jul 31, 2025 

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Behind Apple's Blowout Quarter: iPhones, MacBooks And China

Erick Schonfeld — 3:28 PM PDT · April 20, 2011

It is difficult to understate what a run Apple is on right now. Look no further than the [blowout earnings](#) Apple reported today for its second fiscal quarter ended in March. Revenues were up 83 percent to \$24.7 billion, and profits grew even faster, up 95 percent to \$6 billion. Growth was strong across the board (with the exception of iPad sales which suffered from supply constraints and built up “the mother of all backlogs,” according to CFO Peter Oppenheimer).

But if you dive into the numbers (click table to enlarge), you will see that three areas drove the overall growth more than any others: iPhones, MacBooks and China. The iPhone now makes up [half of Apple's revenues](#), or \$12.3 billion in the quarter. Sales grew 126 percent in dollar terms, with unit sales up 113 percent. In the U.S. alone, iPhone sales were up 155 percent. Bringing Verizon on board helped goose the numbers, but AT&T wasn't exactly complaining either.

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Apple Inc.
Q2 2011 Unaudited Summary Data

	Q2 2011		Q2 2010		Q2 2011		Q2 2010		Sequential Change		Year/Year Change	
	Units	Revenue \$M	Units	Revenue \$M	Units	Revenue \$M	Units	Revenue \$M	Q1/Q4	Revenue	Q1/Q4	Revenue
Operating Segments												
iPhone (1)	1,982	\$8,218	871	\$4,053	1,217	\$5,323	1,000	\$1,441	+176%	155%	+226%	80%
MacBook	1,241	7,236	899	4,525	995	5,027	825	3,027	+49%	+28%	+20%	+68%
Tablet (2)	162	1,413	339	387	135	1,383	135	1,383	-44%	-28%	+20%	+100%
Other (3)	916	4,887	238	1,488	388	4,743	388	4,743	+50%	+38%	+29%	+112%
Total	881	3,887	808	1,853	737	3,181	737	3,181	+9%	+17%	+37%	+83%
Total Operating Segments	5,134	\$26,761	2,813	\$13,869	3,732	\$24,857	3,732	\$24,857	+8%	+8%	+23%	+83%
Product Summary												
iPhone (1)	1,982	\$8,218	871	\$4,053	1,217	\$5,323	1,000	\$1,441	+176%	155%	+226%	80%
MacBook (2)	1,241	7,236	899	4,525	995	5,027	825	3,027	+49%	+28%	+20%	+68%
Tablet (3)	162	1,413	339	387	135	1,383	135	1,383	-44%	-28%	+20%	+100%
Other (4)	916	4,887	238	1,488	388	4,743	388	4,743	+50%	+38%	+29%	+112%
Segment (5)	4,134	5,430	2,843	3,763	3,732	4,876	3,732	4,876	+9%	+8%	+23%	+83%
Other (6)	70	457	70	457	5	105	5	105	-92%	-92%	+100%	+100%
Product (7)	16,315	14,117	16,315	14,117	16,315	14,117	16,315	14,117	+17%	+17%	+17%	+17%
Other (8)	2,311	4,628	0	0	4,628	2,634	4,628	2,634	+30%	+30%	+30%	+30%
Product (9)	18,626	18,745	16,315	14,117	20,943	16,751	20,943	16,751	+15%	+15%	+15%	+15%
Other (10)	166	166	166	166	166	166	166	166	-5%	-5%	+20%	+20%
Product (11)	18,792	18,911	16,481	14,283	21,109	16,917	21,109	16,917	+13%	+13%	+13%	+13%
Total Apple	8,926	\$24,761	5,654	\$13,869	7,469	\$24,857	7,469	\$24,857	+8%	+8%	+23%	+83%

(1) Includes only the iPhone. (2) Includes the MacBook Air and MacBook Pro. (3) Includes the iPad. (4) Includes the iPod touch. (5) Includes the Apple TV. (6) Includes the Apple Watch. (7) Includes the Apple TV. (8) Includes the Apple Watch. (9) Includes the Apple TV. (10) Includes the Apple Watch. (11) Includes the Apple TV.

As fast as U.S. sales of iPhones keep growing, it is not the fastest growing region. In “Greater China,” iPhone sales were up 250 percent. Sales of all products across Asia Pacific were up 151 percent to \$4.7 billion. In contrast, Europe is a \$6 billion region for Apple, and the Americas is \$9.3 billion. “Greater China” (which presumably includes Hong Kong, Taiwan and other Asian markets, could soon become Apple’s second largest region.

Finally, Apple’s MacBook sales were up 59 percent to \$3.5 billion in the quarter. Those MacBook Airs are very popular. Half of all Macs (both portable and desktop) sold were to new customers switching from Windows. Sales from its own retail stores were up 90 percent overall in the quarter to \$3.2 billion. And the iTunes store (which is all music, movies, and apps) is now doing \$1.4 billion a quarter.

So what happened to the iPad? Apple sold only 4.7 million iPads, compared to 7.3 million in the December quarter. To some extent consumers delayed purchases in anticipation of the iPad 2, which came out at the end of the quarter. Apple sold every iPad 2 it could make, but supply issues impacted how many it could manufacture. Apple says the iPad supply issues are now resolved, at least for this quarter.

And what about Steve Jobs (who is on medical leave and was not on the earnings call)? Asked about Jobs’ active role in the company, acting CEO Tim Cook responded: “We do see him on a regular basis. He is involved in major strategic decisions. I know he wants to be back full time as soon as he can.”

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What the iPhone 11 says about Apple's present — and future

Hardware events are no longer really about hardware

Brian Heater

2:57 PM PDT · September 10, 2019

No matter how much polish and Apple magic the company put on today's big event, there was one unshakable truth that colored the goings-on: [phones just aren't selling like they used to](#). And unlike other industry-wide trends, Apple isn't immune. The large-scale slowdown of smartphone sales has had an undeniable impact on the company's bottom line.

Casual observers may not have noticed, but that harsh truth impacted nearly every mobile announcement onstage today at the Steve Jobs theater. Two elements in particular really stood out, however:

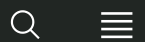
Content and services taking center stage.

Apple rethinking how the iPhone is positioned.

The first was clear right out of the gate. CEO Tim Cook opened the show by noting that the two-hour event would be so jam-packed with announcements that it was better to get out of the way and let the news do the talking. He then surrendered the stage to several gaming demos for Apple Arcade. After that, it was Apple TV+ trailers.

Of course, we've known for a while that software and services have and will continue to become an increasingly important part of the company's bottom line, especially as the iPhone has become a less reliable revenue stream. But the act of stepping out of the way to let games and TV shows do the talking was a suitably on-the-nose metaphor for the shift. So too was the way in which hardware advances like the A13 chip were filtered through a gaming lens.

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The other key factor in slowed sales is escalating pricing. When Apple introduced the iPhone X a few years back, the \$1,000 price point boggled the mind, especially for users who were accustomed to purchasing devices tied to cellular contracts. In 2019, however, the \$1,000 flagship is just a fact of life. It's no wonder companies aren't selling as many devices.

Apple's initial fix for this was the launch of the iPhone XR, a "budget" alternative to the X/XS line that kept the pricing of earlier models while adopting the new form factor. With [the arrival of the iPhone 11](#), however, things have shifted. The iPhone R's true successor is the iPhone 11, while the iPhone XS and XS Max have given way to the 11 Pro and 11 Pro Max, respectively.

This new positioning means Apple is able to position the more budget device as an "entry-level flagship," even while maintaining a similar 6.1-inch TrueTone LCD display as the iPhone XR. Once again, the company distinguishes the standard from the Pros with a different display and camera array. It's similar to the approach it's taken on the iPad line, with the "pros" here referring to those who shoot on their iPhone for work.

It's no coincidence the company trotted out Sean Baker. The director's critically acclaimed films "The Florida Project" and "Tangerine" are routinely held up as examples of iPhone-shooting done right. Apple is clearly hoping that continued camera improvements will convince even more creatives to ditch the SLR.

For what was ostensibly a hardware event, the new devices took a bit of a backseat to content offerings. The era of giant hardware launches may be ending — or at the very least, ebbing. Smartphones certainly don't drive consumer excitement the way they once did. Thankfully for Apple's sake, however, the company's got another billion-dollar bet waiting in the wings.



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Brian Heater

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Brian Heater was the Hardware Editor at TechCrunch until early 2025. He has worked for a number of leading tech publications, including Engadget, PCMag, Laptop, and Tech Times, where he served as the...

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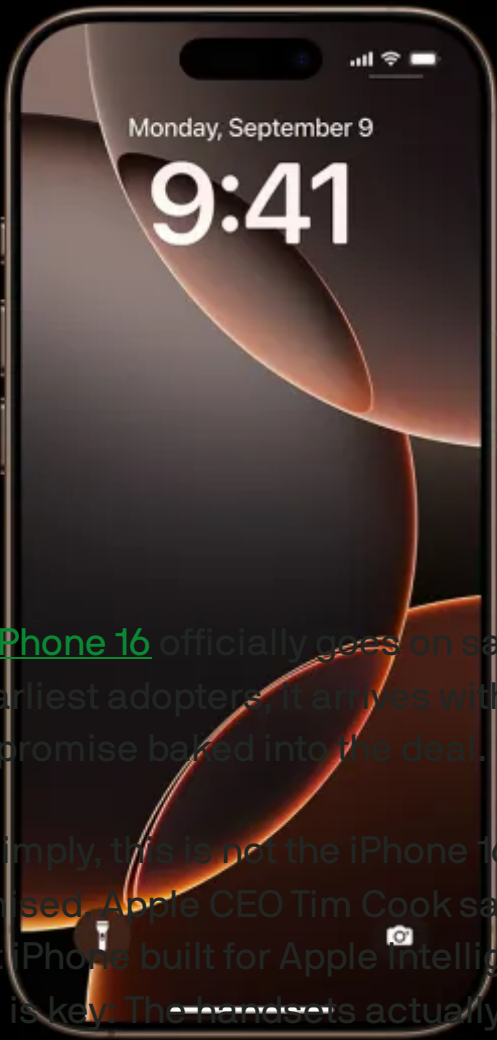
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The iPhone 16 launches
today without its most

hyped feature: Apple Intelligence

Ivan Mehta — 11:30 AM PDT · September 20, 2024



The [iPhone 16](#) officially goes on sale Friday. But for its earliest adopters, it arrives with a fundamental compromise baked into the deal.

Put simply, this is not the iPhone 16 that they were promised. Apple CEO Tim Cook said it would be the “first iPhone built for Apple Intelligence.” But that “for” is key: The handsets actually will not have its most hyped AI features out of the gate.

IMAGE CREDITS: APPLE

This feels like a turning point for Apple. When it comes to new features on phones, the company may not always be known for being the first to market or for jumping on gimmicks, but it is known for being the best. That’s not the case here. Apple was compelled to board the AI hype train and is thus [taking a leap into the half-baked void](#).

Apple has now talked about its Apple Intelligence suite twice — first when announcing the AI suite [at its Worldwide Developer Conference \(WWDC\) in June](#), and second during its [September iPhone 16 launch](#).

[iPhone 16 Pro Max review: A \\$1,200 glimpse at a more intelligent future](#)

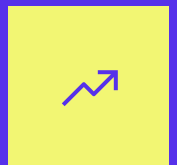
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But in actuality, the company is far behind in terms of shipping features when it comes to its competitors like Google and Microsoft, as well as upstarts like OpenAI and Anthropic.

The company's first set of AI tools, announced and [released in developer betas](#), are rewriting tools, summarizations of articles and notifications, [erasing objects in photos](#), and audio transcription. Much of this functionality already exists in the market. Apple's bet is that its decisions around privacy — your usage data is not shared with other users, or with other tech companies, it promises — will be enough to attract buyers.

Strictly speaking, the gap between product and feature is not as dramatic as you might think — or at least that is how Apple would defend all this. The iPhone went on sale on September 20, and Apple has promised to start launching its AI features in October.

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Yet only a handful of features will be made live at that time, and they will only be in U.S. English. (Recall that the company counts heavily on international markets, with North America accounting for just over half of all iPhone unit sales.)

And for the more complicated AI bells and whistles, we all still have to wait. The company plans to roll out features like [visual search](#) and Image Playground starting next month, while additional language support is starting to be rolled out in December — but first with localized English. Other languages will [arrive sometime in 2025](#).

The iPhone 16 isn't strictly necessary for those who want the new AI features. The company has already confirmed that the iPhone 15 Pro and 15 Pro Max will also get access to the platform.

So if Apple Intelligence is going to be a game changer as Apple promises, it's fair to wonder if the rollout gaps and delays will keep users from upgrading. Or, if we start to see consumers adopt more of a wait-and-see approach — which might also translate to lower sales.

However, as my colleague Sarah Perez pointed out, Apple's AI features could become more useful once [third-party developers are able to fully integrate them with their apps](#). That's worth considering, if and when it happens, but that's more of a conversation for the iPhone 17.

That might well be the point here. Apple is building for the longer term opportunities, and for the first time, it feels like it's asking buyers to take that leap of faith with it.

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